way. Representatives of other industrial firms interviewed me after Carbide and Carbon had, but all of them, without exception, showed a monumental lack of interest. There was every sign that I might reach my degree with empty hands and become a supereducated member of the unemployed.

Industry, however, isn't the only possible source of work. There is also the academic world. I was told that Erwin Brand, a biochemist at Physicians and Surgeons, needed an assistant, so I went up to see him on December 18.

He was a little gnomelike creature, who spoke with machine-gun rapidity between puffs at a cigarette. He chain-smoked. Each cigarette burned down until what was left was virtually invisible between his fingers, and then it grew to full size miraculously. I never quite caught him replacing or lighting a cigarette. He talked without a break for the entire 2 l A hours I was with him.

He didn't exactly offer me the job and I didn't exactly ask for it. In fact, I had the queasy feeling it would be a desperate mistake to take a job with him. He was a prima donna and the trouble was that I was one, too, and there cannot be two on the same project. If I were going

3 See Second Foundation (Gnome, 1952, later Doubleday), where it appears as Part I—"Search by the Mule."

to work for someone it would have to be for a gentle soul with infinite patience and a wide tolerance, like Dawson.

I did ask about the salary out of curiosity. I suggested $4,000 per year and he countered with $3,600. In Navy Yard terms, I was asking for a P3 and he was offering a P2—so that 2V2 more years had passed and I still wasn't getting a promotion.

I came back to Columbia quite depressed and Dawson comforted me, telling me I wasn't to take that job and he would be sure to find me a better one. (Poor fellow. He couldn't invent a job where none existed, but then I didn't really expect him to find me one.)

Roy Machlowitz came to see us every time he was in New York, it seemed to me. He was in town for ten days over the Christmas season of 1947 and he called up to arrange a trip to some museum. The date set was December 26, 1947.

The forecast on Christmas night was for "light snow" the next day, and I was at once dubious. I don't believe "light snow" forecasts.